Dr. Bastián **González-Bustamante**

Postdoctoral Researcher in Computational Social Science · Leiden University

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Summary

I am a Postdoctoral Researcher in Computational Social Science at Leiden University. I hold a DPhil (PhD) in Politics from the University of Oxford. My work bridges comparative politics, government and computational social science, with a particular interest in relational structures, political careers and political behaviour. I have applied social network analysis and graph-based methods to study political elites, legislative careers and co-sponsorship, including analyses of network structure and homogeneity in legislatures and applications of algorithms to political elite networks. I have also used network analysis to examine the intellectual structure of academic fields. More broadly, I build large-scale relational and text-as-data pipelines, deploy AI and machine learning models, and apply causal inference strategies to complex observational data. My recent peer-reviewed articles have appeared in *Nature*, *Social Science Computer Review*, *Public Opinion Quarterly*, *World Development*, *Artificial Intelligence and Law*, and *Digital Journalism*, among others.

My current research combines large-scale behavioural, relational and textual data to study political actors, institutions and patterns of interaction. Recent work analyses more than 21 million social-media posts to examine amplification, contestation and toxic interactions around protest news, combining machine learning with causal inference. I am also working on the Terrorist Group Adaptation & Lessons for Counterterrorism (TERGAP) project, funded by the European Union, to build a new dataset of counterterrorism events and identify patterns of adaptation and unintended effects of counterterrorism. In parallel, I contribute to COST Action CA22150 on executive-bureaucratic careers and serve as a Research Leader at the Oxford Computational Political Science Group.

Education

University of Oxford — **Oxford, GBR**
DPhil (PhD) in Politics — 2019 – 2023
Dissertation: *Critical events and ministerial turnover in Latin American presidential democracies*

Universidad de Chile — **Santiago, CHL**
MA in Political Science — 2010 – 2013
Highest Distinction (1st, First-class honours)

Universidad de Chile — **Santiago, CHL**
BA in Government — 2004 – 2009
Distinction (2:1, Second-class honours, upper division)

Universidad de Chile — **Santiago, CHL**
BPS in Public Administration — 2004 – 2009
Distinction (2:1, Second-class honours, upper division)

Relevant Employment

University of Oxford — **Oxford, GBR**
Research Leader — 2025 – today
Oxford Computational Political Science Group (OCPSG)

Leiden University — **The Hague, NLD**
Postdoctoral Researcher in Computational Social Science — 2023 – today
Faculty of Governance and Global Affairs

Universidad Diego Portales (UDP) — **Santiago, CHL**
Lecturer — 2024 – today
Faculty of Administration and Economics

Universidad de Santiago de Chile (USACH) **Santiago, CHL**
Lecturer 2014 – 2019
Faculty of Administration and Economics

United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) **Santiago, CHL**
Consultant 2016 – 2017
Democratic Governance Programme

Featured Publications

15. Orchard, X., **González-Bustamante, B.**, & Cisternas, C. (2026). Amplification, Contestation, and Toxic Interactions with Protest News: How Social Upheaval Reshapes Dynamics between News Organisations and Their Audiences. *Digital Journalism*, 1–22. DOI: 10.1080/21670811.2026.2730335.

14. **González-Bustamante, B.**, & Kantorowicz, J. (2026). Uncovering the Rule of Law in European Countries. *Law & Social Inquiry*. FirstView. DOI: 10.1017/lsi.2026.10151.

13. Aczel, B., Szaszi, B., Clelland, H.T., et al. (including **González-Bustamante, B.**) (2026). Investigating the analytical robustness of the social and behavioural sciences. *Nature*, 652, 135–142. DOI: 10.1038/s41586-025-09844-9.

12. **González-Bustamante, B.** (2026). Machine Learning and Political Events: Application of a Semi-supervised Approach to Produce a Dataset on Presidential Cabinets. *Social Science Computer Review, 44*(2), 245–258. DOI: 10.1177/08944393251315917.

11. **González-Bustamante, B.** (2026). Blame-Shifting in Presidential Systems: Corrective Effect of Ministerial Terminations on Approval. *Public Opinion Quarterly, 90*(1), 96–117. DOI: 10.1093/poq/nfaf061. SocArXiv: 10.31235/osf.io/37ruy_v2.

10. Kantorowicz, J., & **González-Bustamante, B.** (2025). Exploring the Rule of Law in Academic Discourse: Bibliometric Description and Thematic Analysis with the Web of Science Data. *European Journal of Empirical Legal Studies, 2*(3). DOI: 10.62355/ejels.55001. OSF: 10.31219/osf.io/sgf8y.

9. Kantorowicz, J., & **González-Bustamante, B.** (2025). Changing Meaning of the Rule of Law. *Artificial Intelligence and Law*. OnlineFirst. DOI: 10.1007/s10506-025-09468-4. OSF: 10.31219/osf.io/2kzpj.

8. Fleming, T. G., **González-Bustamante, B.**, & Schleiter, P. (2024). Cabinet Reshuffles and Parliamentary No-Confidence Motions. *Government and Opposition, 59*(4), 1274–1288. DOI: 10.1017/gov.2022.23.

7. Orchard, X., & **González-Bustamante, B.** (2024). Power Hierarchies and Visibility in the News: Exploring Determinants of Politicians' Presence and Prominence in the Chilean Press (1991-2019). *The International Journal of Press/Politics, 29*(1), 100–123. DOI: 10.1177/19401612221089482.

6. **González-Bustamante, B.** (2023). Ministerial stability during presidential approval crises: The moderating effect of ministers' attributes on dismissals in Brazil and Chile. *The British Journal of Politics and International Relations, 25*(4), 655–675. DOI: 10.1177/13691481221124850.

5. **González-Bustamante, B.**, & Aguilar, D. (2023). Territorial patterns of open e-government: evidence from Chilean municipalities. *Political Research Exchange, 5*(1). DOI: 10.1080/2474736X.2023.2194369. SocArXiv: 10.31235/osf.io/gt8a5.

4. **González-Bustamante, B.** (2021). Evolution and early government responses to COVID-19 in South America. *World Development, 137*, 105180. DOI: 10.1016/j.worlddev.2020.105180.

3. **González-Bustamante, B.** (2020). The Politics-Administration Dichotomy: A Case Study of the Chilean Executive During the Democratic Post-Transition. *Bulletin of Latin American Research, 39*(5), 582–597. DOI: 10.1111/blar.13044. SocArXiv: 10.31235/osf.io/d52au.

2. Maillet, A., **González-Bustamante, B.**, & Olivares, A. (2019). Public-Private Circulation and the Revolving Door in the Chilean Executive Branch (2000-2014). *Latin American Business Review, 20*(4), 367–387. DOI: 10.1080/10978526.2019.1652099.

1. **González-Bustamante, B.** (2018). Civil Service Models in Latin America. In A. Farazmand (ed.), *Global Encyclopedia of Public Administration, Public Policy, and Governance*. Springer. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-319-20928-9_2699. SocArXiv: 10.31235/osf.io/mp4qd.

Relevant Research Projects

- **Terrorist Group Adaptation & Lessons for Counterterrorism.** ERC, TERGAP, 101116436, Research Associate (Graig R. Klein, Principal Investigator), 2024-2028. — **European Union**
- **Making Finance Sustainable? A Comparative Perspective on the Politics of Investment.** Vidi SGW VI.Vidi.211.22, Research Associate (Natascha van der Zwan, Principal Investigator), 2023-2028. — **Dutch Research Agency**
- **Comparative Research on the Executive Triangle in Europe (CoREx).** COST Action CA22150, supported by COST (European Cooperation in Science and Technology), WG2 Research Associate (Jan-Hinrik Meyer-Sahling, WG2 Leader), 2023-2027. — **European Cooperation**
- **Benchmarking LLMs and Fine-Tuned Models for Multilingual Policy Agenda Annotation in European Parliamentary Speeches.** Department of Politics and International Relations and Oxford Computational Political Science Group, Principal Investigator, 2025-2026. — **Oxford**
- **Unpacking the Unpredictable: Using NLP and LLMs to Examine Cabinet Politics and Responses to Stochastic Events in Presidential Democracies.** UDP Inserción/Enlace Fund 2025-2026, Principal Investigator, 2025-2026. — **UDP**
- **Time Use and Relationship with Cultural Participation Profiles.** Chilean Undersecretariat of Cultures and the Arts under the 1725-384-COT25 service provision agreement with Empiria Lab, Consultancy Chief, 2025. — **Undersecretariat of Cultures and the Arts**
- **Validating a Gold Standard for Measuring Political Toxicity and Incivility in the Digital Sphere.** Internal Project 2024 Faculty of Administration and Economics at Universidad Diego Portales (UDP), Principal Investigator, 2024-2025. — **UDP**
- **Unravelling the Rule of Law: A Machine Learning Approach.** XS 406.XS.01.013, Research Associate (Jaroslaw Kantorowicz, Principal Investigator), 2023-2024. — **Dutch Research Agency**
- **Large Language Models (LLMs) to Identify Toxicity in the Digital Sphere during Protest Events in Latin America.** OpenAI Academic Programme, Principal Investigator, 2024. — **OpenAI**
- **Territorial Patterns of Electronic and Open Government in Chilean Municipalities.** Internal Project USA 2156 POC2022_FAE2 at Universidad de Santiago de Chile (USACH), Principal Investigator, 2022. — **USACH**

Recent Honours & Awards

- 2026 — **Young Researcher and Innovator Conference Grant.** European Cooperation in Science and Technology grant for participating in PolMeth Europe 2026 Conference. — **Dublin, IRL**
- 2023 — **Early Career Scholar Award.** Best early career work and travel support for the BigSurv23 Conference. — **Quito, ECU**
- 2023 — **ECPR Joint Sessions of Workshops Grant.** Travel support for the European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) Joint Sessions of Workshops. — **Toulouse, FRA**

2022	**SLAS Postgraduate and Postdoctoral Research Award and Conference Grant.** Research support grant for my DPhil (PhD) project and travel support for the Society for Latin American Studies (SLAS) Annual Conference.	**Bath, GBR**
2022	**St Hilda's College Muriel Wise Fund and Travel and Book Grants.** Research support grant for my DPhil (PhD) project and allowances for participation in conferences and purchase of books.	**Oxford, GBR**
2019	**Becas Chile Doctoral Scholarship Abroad.** Tuition fees, transport and living expenses for pursuing a DPhil (PhD) at the University of Oxford (ANID/PFCHA/72200340).	**Oxford, GBR**

Selected Conference Presentations

** Selection of only the last five years*

2026	Latin American Political Science Association (ALACIP) — Congress	**Buenos Aires, ARG**
2026	European Political Science Society (EPSS) — Annual Conference	**Belfast, GBR**
2026	PolMeth Europe — Conference	**Dublin, IRL**
2026	COMPTEXT — Conference	**Birmingham, GBR**
2025	ODISSEI — Conference for Social Sciences in the Netherlands	**Utrecht, NLD**
2025	International Political Science Association (IPSA) — World Congress	**Seoul, KOR**
2025	European Political Science Association (EPSA) — Annual Conference	**Madrid, ESP**
2025	European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) — Joint Sessions	**Prague, CZE**
2025	COMPTEXT — Conference	**Vienna, AUT**
2025	Netherlands Institute of Governance (NIG) — 21st Annual Conference	**Ghent, BEL**
2024	ODISSEI — Conference for Social Sciences in the Netherlands	**Utrecht, NLD**
2024	Digital Society Initiative — Digital Democracy Workshop	**Zurich, CHE**
2024	Latin American Political Science Association (ALACIP) — Congress	**Lisbon, PRT**
2024	Society for Latin American Studies (SLAS) — Annual Conference	**Amsterdam, NLD**
2024	COMPTEXT — Conference	**Amsterdam, NLD**
2023	BigSurv — Conference	**Quito, ECU**
2023	European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) — General Conference	**Prague, CZE**
2023	International Political Science Association (IPSA) — World Congress	**Buenos Aires, ARG**
2023	Political Studies Association Early Career Network (PSA-ECN) — Annual Conference	**Virtual**
2023	European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) — Joint Sessions	**Toulouse, FRA**
2023	Political Studies Association (PSA) — Annual International Conference	**Liverpool, GBR**
2023	Society for Latin American Studies (SLAS) — Annual Conference	**Belfast, GBR**
2022	Digital Society Initiative — Digital Democracy Workshop	**Zurich, CHE**
2022	International Political Science Association (IPSA) — Seminar	**Madrid, ESP**

2022	Latin American Political Science Association (ALACIP) — Congress	**Virtual**
2022	Political Studies Association Early Career Network (PSA-ECN) — Annual Conference	**Virtual**
2022	The R User Conference 2022 (userR) — Annual Conference	**Virtual**
2022	Latin American Studies Association (LASA) — International Congress	**Virtual**
2022	Society for Latin American Studies (SLAS) — Annual Conference	**Bath, GBR**

Languages & Software

Languages Spanish (native speaker), English (fluent), Portuguese (advanced reading skills), Dutch, French and Italian (elemental reading skills)

Programming & Software Python, R, Git, Stata, SPSS/PSPP, Gephi, UCINET, NetDraw, Tosmana, ArcGIS, ATLAS.ti, HPoP, Zotero, JabRef, LaTeX, BibTeX, MS Office, WordPress, Moodle, JAVA, HTML, CSS, XHTML